



Now I need the complete documentation how and what to do ? also what is the purpose of it and how it looks like in meraki ? also in meraki what I need to do? how can I have the complete SDA workflow in meraki ? from planning to implementation like what we have in SDA

Here is your complete end-to-end documentation — from planning on paper to a live LISP+VXLAN fabric running through Meraki, with no Catalyst Center.

Complete SDA Deployment via Meraki — Zero CC

What Is This and Why Are We Building It?

SD-Access is fundamentally just LISP + VXLAN + Policy running on IOS-XE switches. Catalyst Center is the *optional* orchestrator that configures these protocols — not a mandatory piece of the fabric itself. What you are building is a **Meraki Workflow** that replaces CC's guided setup wizard by pushing the same LISP and VXLAN YANG configuration directly to your switches via IOS-XE RESTCONF API. The end result is identical to a CC-deployed SDA fabric, just without the CC infrastructure dependency.

Phase Overview

Every phase has a clear purpose and a specific set of actions. Nothing overlaps.

☒ PHASE 0 — Planning (Before Touching Anything)

This is the most important phase. SDA deployment without a controller requires you to pre-plan everything that CC would normally calculate for you automatically.

0.1 — Topology Design

Assign roles to your two switches:

Switch	Role	Why
C9500	Border Node + Control Plane Node	C9500 is the most powerful — it handles BGP L3 handoff to external network AND runs the LISP Map Server/Resolver brain

Switch	Role	Why
C9300	Fabric Edge Node	C9300 connects end devices — it encapsulates traffic into VXLAN tunnels toward C9500

0.2 — IP Address Schema

Plan all IPs before you start. Write these down:

MANAGEMENT NETWORK

C9500 Mgmt IP: 192.168.1.100 /24
 C9300 Mgmt IP: 192.168.1.101 /24
 Relay Server IP: 192.168.1.50 /24
 Gateway: 192.168.1.1

UNDERLAY NETWORK (Loopback – VTEP source)

C9500 Lo0: 10.255.255.1/32
 C9300 Lo0: 10.255.255.2/32
 OSPF Area: 0

OVERLAY NETWORK (User traffic inside VXLAN)

CORP_VN Data: 192.168.10.0/24 → VLAN 100 → VNI 100
 CORP_VN Voice: 192.168.20.0/24 → VLAN 200 → VNI 200

LISP

Instance ID: 100
 Map Server IP: 10.255.255.1 (C9500 Lo0)
 Map Resolver IP: 10.255.255.1 (same device for POC)

BGP (Border Handoff)

C9500 Internal AS: 65001
 Upstream Router: 192.168.1.1
 Upstream AS: 65000

0.3 — Port Planning

C9500 TenGigabitEthernet1/0/1 → Uplink to router (BGP)
 C9500 TenGigabitEthernet1/0/2 → VXLAN trunk to C9300
 C9300 GigabitEthernet1/0/1 → Trunk to C9500
 C9300 GigabitEthernet1/0/10 → Access port for end device (VLAN 100)

☒ PHASE 1 — Switch Preparation (CLI — One Time Only)

This phase is done once via CLI or Cloud CLI in Meraki. After this, everything else is automated.

1.1 — C9500 Base Configuration

```
! — Management —————
interface Vlan1
 ip address 192.168.1.100 255.255.255.0
 no shutdown

! — Loopback (VTEP Source) —————
interface Loopback0
 ip address 10.255.255.1 255.255.255.255
 no shutdown

! — Enable RESTCONF —————
restconf
ip http secure-server
ip http secure-ciphersuite HIGH
netconf-yang

! — OSPF Underlay —————
router ospf 1
 network 10.255.255.1 0.0.0.0 area 0
 network 192.168.1.0 0.0.0.255 area 0

write memory
```

1.2 — C9300 Base Configuration

```
! — Management —————
interface Vlan1
 ip address 192.168.1.101 255.255.255.0
 no shutdown

! — Loopback (VTEP Source) —————
interface Loopback0
 ip address 10.255.255.2 255.255.255.255
 no shutdown

! — Enable RESTCONF —————
restconf
ip http secure-server
ip http secure-ciphersuite HIGH
netconf-yang

! — OSPF Underlay —————
router ospf 1
 network 10.255.255.2 0.0.0.0 area 0
 network 192.168.1.0 0.0.0.255 area 0

write memory
```

1.3 — Verify Everything Is Ready

On both switches, run:

```
show ip http secure server status
! Must show: HTTP Secure server status: Listen on port 443

show yang module | include lisp
! Must show: cisco-ios-xe-lisp

ping 10.255.255.2 source Loopback0
! C9500 must reach C9300 Loopback via OSPF
```

🏔 PHASE 2 — Meraki Dashboard Setup

This is where you work entirely inside `dashboard.meraki.com`. Here is exactly what it looks like and where to click:

2.1 — Onboard Switches to Meraki (Cloud Monitoring Mode)

Where: `Organization` → `Devices` → `Add Devices`

1. Go to `Organization` → `Configure` → `Cloud Monitoring for Catalyst`
2. Click `Add Devices`
3. Enter C9500 and C9300 management IPs
4. Follow the onboarding wizard — push a small monitoring config to each switch
5. After 2–3 minutes both switches show as  `Online` under `Organization` → `Monitor` → `Devices`

What you see in Meraki after this:

- Device list showing C9500 and C9300 with hostname, IP, IOS XE version, uptime
- Topology map showing the link between C9500 and C9300
- Interface stats, CPU, memory — all visible in real-time

Important: This puts switches in **Cloud Monitoring mode** — Meraki watches them, but does NOT manage their config. This is exactly what you want — your relay server + RESTCONF owns the config.

2.2 — Add the Relay Target

Where: `Organization` → `Automation` → `Workflows` → `Targets`

1. Click `Add Target`
2. Fill in:

```
Name:      SDA_Relay
Type:      HTTPS (or HTTP for local lab)
```

```
URL: http://192.168.1.50:5000
Authentication: None (or Bearer Token for security)
```

3. Click Test Connection

4. Expected result: "Connected — HTTP 200"

If using ngrok to expose relay to Meraki cloud:

URL = https://xxxx-xx-xxx-xx.ngrok.io

2.3 — Import the Workflow

Where: Organization → Automation → Workflows

1. Click Import Workflow

2. Upload meraki_workflow_export.json

3. Workflow appears in library as Deploy-SDA-Fabric-LISP-VXLAN

4. Click it to open the Workflow Canvas — drag-and-drop visual editor showing:

```
[Input Form] → [HTTP POST to Relay] → [Condition] → [Success Email] / [Failure Email]
```

You can add, modify, or delete any activity by dragging from the left panel.

☒ PHASE 3 — Deploy the Relay Server

Your relay server is a 50-line Python Flask app running on a VM in your lab. It is the bridge between Meraki cloud and your switches.

3.1 — Run the Relay

On your lab server (Linux/Mac):

```
# Create working directory
mkdir sda-lab && cd sda-lab

# Copy all files (from previous responses) into this folder
# Install dependencies
pip3 install -r requirements.txt

# Edit .env — fill in your switch IPs and passwords
nano .env

# Start relay
python3 sda_relay_server.py
```

Expected output:

```
INFO - Starting SDA Relay Server — Port 5000
INFO - C9500: 192.168.1.100
```

```
INFO - C9300: 192.168.1.101
* Running on http://0.0.0.0:5000
```

3.2 — Test Relay Connectivity to Switches

```
curl http://localhost:5000/health
# {"status": "relay_running", "timestamp": "2026-03-31T21:47:00"}

curl -X POST http://localhost:5000/webhook \
  -H "Content-Type: application/json" \
  -d '{"action": "health_check_devices"}'
# {"status": "success", "c9500_reachable": true, "c9300_reachable": true}
```

Both must return true. If not, fix RESTCONF on the switch before proceeding.

3.3 — Expose Relay to Meraki Cloud (if needed)

If your relay is behind NAT:

```
# Install ngrok
brew install ngrok          # Mac
# OR download from https://ngrok.com/download

# Expose port 5000
ngrok http 5000

# Note the URL displayed:
# Forwarding → https://abc123.ngrok.io → localhost:5000

# Update Meraki Target URL to: https://abc123.ngrok.io
```

☒ PHASE 4 — Execute the Workflow

This is where Meraki becomes your SD-Access deployment wizard.

Where: Organization → Automation → Workflows → Deploy-SDA-Fabric-LISP-VXLAN → Execute

4.1 — Fill in the Workflow Form

Meraki shows you a clean input form (like a wizard):

☒ Deploy SD-Access Fabric	
Fabric Name:	[POC_SDA_Fabric]
LISP Instance:	[100]
C9500 BGP AS:	[65001]
Data VNI:	[100]
Data VLAN:	[100]

[▶ Execute Workflow]

4.2 — What Happens Behind the Scenes

Click Execute and the following happens automatically:

```
Meraki Workflow fires
↓
POST /webhook → SDA_Relay (192.168.1.50:5000)
Body: {action: "deploy_lisp_vxlan", fabric_name: "POC_SDA_Fabric", ...}
↓
Relay Step 1: RESTCONF PUT → C9500
  Endpoint: /restconf/data/Cisco-IOS-XE-lisp:lisp
  Payload: LISP Map Server, Map Resolver, Instance 100
  Result: ✓ HTTP 204 – LISP configured
↓
Relay Step 2: RESTCONF PUT → C9500
  Endpoint: /restconf/data/Cisco-IOS-XE-nve:nve
  Payload: NVE1 source Lo0, VNI 100 → VLAN 100
  Result: ✓ HTTP 204 – VXLAN configured
↓
Relay Step 3: RESTCONF PUT → C9300
  Endpoint: /restconf/data/Cisco-IOS-XE-nve:nve
  Payload: NVE1 source Lo0, VNI 100 → VLAN 100
  Result: ✓ HTTP 204 – VXLAN configured
↓
Relay returns: {"status": "success", "message": "Fabric deployment completed"}
↓
Meraki Workflow: ✓ Condition = success
↓
Meraki Email: "✓ SD-Access Fabric Deployed: POC_SDA_Fabric"
```

4.3 — Monitor in Meraki

Where: Organization → Automation → Workflows → Execution History

You see a real-time log of each activity:

```
✓ Input Form collected
✓ HTTP POST to SDA_Relay – 200 OK
✓ Condition check – passed
✓ Email notification – sent
Total Duration: 18 seconds
```

✓ PHASE 5 — Validation

5.1 — Validate from Meraki Cloud CLI

Where: Organization → Monitor → Devices → C9500 → Tools → Cloud CLI

Type directly in the browser terminal:

```
show lisp site
show lisp instance-id 100 statistics
show lisp map-cache
```

Expected output on C9500:

```
LISP Site Registration Information
* = Some locators are down or unreachable
# = Some registrations are sourced by reliable transport

Site Name      Last      Up      Who Last      Inst      EID Prefix
Register       Registered ID
site_uci       never     yes     --           100       192.168.10.0/24
```

Switch to C9300 in Cloud CLI:

```
show vxlan detail
show interface nve 1
```

Expected output on C9300:

```
Interface NVE1 is up, line protocol is up
Hardware is NVE
Source-Interface: Loopback0 primary IP: 10.255.255.2
Number of L2 VNIs: 1
L2 VNI: 100 VLAN: 100 Type: LISP
```

5.2 — Run Automated Validation Script

```
python3 sda_deployment_validator.py
```

Expected output:

```
✓ RESTCONF Connectivity – C9500: PASSED
✓ RESTCONF Connectivity – C9300: PASSED
✓ LISP on C9500: PASSED
✓ VXLAN NVE – C9500: PASSED
✓ VXLAN NVE – C9300: PASSED
✓ VNI 100 → VLAN 100 Mapping: PASSED
```

RESULT: 6 passed, 0 failed

5.3 — End-to-End Connectivity Test

Connect a laptop to C9300 GigabitEthernet1/0/10. It should:

1. Receive an IP from 192.168.10.0/24 (DHCP from your server or static)
2. Be reachable from C9500 via the VXLAN tunnel
3. Show up as a LISP endpoint registration on C9500:

```
show lisp instance-id 100 database
```

What You Have vs What CC Provides — Comparison

Step	Catalyst Center	Your Meraki Workflow
Site design	GUI tree builder	IP schema on paper
IP Pool management	CC built-in IPAM	Pre-planned manually
Fabric creation	One-click guided wizard	Workflow form → relay
Auth profile	Dropdown (No Auth / ISE)	Hardcoded in relay (No Auth)
Virtual Network	GUI form	YANG payload via RESTCONF
Device role assignment	Drag device to role	Relay pushes LISP/VXLAN YANG
Port onboarding	GUI port picker	RESTCONF interface payload
Monitoring	CC Assurance dashboard	Meraki Dashboard + Cloud CLI
Validation	CC built-in checks	Your validator script
Day-N changes	CC templates	Update YANG payload + re-run

Troubleshooting Quick Reference

Symptom	Cause	Fix
Relay health check fails	Relay not running	<code>python3 sda_relay_server.py</code>
<code>c9500_reachable:</code> <code>false</code>	RESTCONF not enabled	<code>restconf + ip http secure-server</code> on switch
HTTP 422 from RESTCONF	YANG payload invalid	Check <code>Cisco-IOS-XE-lisp.yang</code> for required fields
Meraki Workflow times out	Relay not internet-reachable	Start ngrok, update Meraki Target URL

Symptom	Cause	Fix
show lisp site empty	LISP not applied to interface	Add lisp mobility under interface config
VXLAN tunnel down	OSPF underlay broken	show ip ospf neighbor — C9500 must see C9300

What Comes Next — Your Growth Path

TODAY (POC)

- └ Manual pre-config on switches
- └ Relay server on local VM
- └ Meraki Workflow with manual form input
- └ Single site

PHASE 2

- └ Pre-config via RESTCONF too (zero CLI)
- └ Relay behind HTTPS with API key auth
- └ Workflow triggered by schedule or alert

PHASE 3

- └ Store all configs in Git (YAML)
- └ GitHub webhook triggers Meraki Workflow
- └ Full GitOps – every change tracked

PHASE 4

- └ Multi-site: Relay at every branch
- └ Meraki Workflows loops across 50 sites
- └ Single dashboard deploys fabric everywhere

This is not a workaround. This is Cisco's own infrastructure APIs used the way they were designed to be used — openly, programmatically, and without mandatory dependency on any single controller.